SCHOLASTIC ACTION

ISSUE-AT-A-GLANCE: September 2016

READING LEVELS AND SKILLS FOR ALL ARTICLES IN THIS ISSUE

PAGE	ARTICLE	READING LEVEL	ALTERNATE LEVELS	SPOTLIGHT SKILLS
2	MINI READ **The Coolest Dog in America**	Lexile 770L/ Dale-Chall Grade 4/GRL R	N/A	• Reading Comprehension
4	IN THE NEWS **The Truth About ISIS**	Lexile 710L/ Dale-Chall Grade 3.5/ GRL V	Higher Level: Lexile 890L Lower Level: Lexile 510L	• Summarizing • Vocabulary
9	NONFICTION/HISTORY **Lost in Death Valley**	Lexile 540L/ Dale-Chall Grade 2.5/ GRL T	Higher Level: Lexile 830L Lower Level: Lexile 430L	• Text Evidence • Vocabulary
14	TRUE TEEN STORY **I Saved My Friend's Life**	Lexile 500L/ Dale-Chall Grade 2.5/ GRL T	Higher Level: Lexile 920L Lower Level: Lexile 430L	• Inferences • Vocabulary
18	PARAGRAPH POWER **When Killer Mice Attack!**	Lexile 600L/ Dale-Chall Grade 3/GRL S	Higher Level: Lexile 870L Lower Level: Lexile 510L	• Paragraph Writing
20	READERS THEATER PLAY **Escape From Slavery**	Dale-Chall Grade 3/GRL T	N/A	• Reading With Expression • Fluency • Vocabulary
26	PAIRED TEXTS **Hamburger History/ Tacos Take Over**	Lexile 660L/ Dale-Chall Grade 3/GRL T	Higher Level: Lexile 900L Lower Level: Lexile 520L	• Compare and Contrast • Vocabulary
30	DEBATE **Is It Wrong to Talk About the Election?**	Lexile 660L/ Dale-Chall Grade 3/GRL S	Higher Level: Lexile 940L Lower Level: Lexile 510L	• Opinion Writing
32	POEM **The Rose That Grew From Concrete**	N/A	N/A	• Theme

ANSWER KEY

Answers to skills exercises appearing in the SEPTEMBER 2016 student edition

The Coolest Dog in America, page 2

1. essential, critical

2. By chasing birds away from the airport, Piper is helping to solve the problem of birds flying into plane engines.

3. *Answers will vary but should be one of these:* "Since Piper started working at the airport in Michigan, there have been fewer birds around the runways." "But Piper isn't just helping the planes and passengers." "He's also keeping the birds out of danger."

The Truth About ISIS, page 8

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

1. ISIS is a terrorist group. ISIS leaders want to create a pure Muslim kingdom.

2. ISIS harms Muslims and non-Muslims. ISIS harms people who live in countries it controls. ISIS harms people who do not follow its strict rules.

3. ISIS controls large parts of Iraq and Syria. ISIS also controls areas in Afghanistan, Libya, and Nigeria.

4. People join ISIS because they have no hope, or they are poor and powerless. Some people join ISIS because they have lost loved ones to war or violence and want revenge. Other people join because ISIS promises them money, houses, and glory.

5. The U.S. and other countries are trying to stop ISIS by bombing parts of Iraq and Syria that are controlled by ISIS. The U.S. and other countries are launching more missions against ISIS leaders. Muslim religious leaders around the world are speaking out against ISIS.

Lost in Death Valley, page 13

1. Answer is provided in the magazine.

2. The women decided to drive toward the trees because they knew that trees need water to survive. Therefore, there would be water near the trees.

3. The women wrote a message in the dirt on their car. Then they left their car on the road. They hoped someone would see it and call for help.

4. Inside one of the trailers, they found oatmeal, beans, beer, and jerky. In the morning, they found a hose attached to a trailer and drank water from it.

"I Saved My Friend's Life," page 17

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

1. I learned CPR because all eighth-graders at my school are required to take a CPR course.

2. I knew it was an emergency because Paris was shaking and her eyes rolled back in her head. I didn't know if I should try to help. I didn't think I knew CPR well enough because I had just finished my course the day before.

3. At first I felt numb. That night, I started to worry that Paris was not OK. I was scared that I hadn't helped her in time or hadn't done CPR correctly.

4. Paris went through something really scary, and I'm just glad I could be there to help her. I feel closer to her because we shared a really scary experience. And I'm so glad she's OK now.

5. Saving Paris's life taught me to trust myself. I feel more confident now, and I know that I will be able to handle an emergency. Now I know that I have to try, even when I'm scared.

When Killer Mice Attack! page 19

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

Topic Sentence: Guam dealt with its big snake problem by feeding the snakes dead mice filled with Tylenol, which poisoned the snakes.

Detail 1: First, scientists realized that Tylenol would kill the snakes.

Detail 2: Next, scientists put the medicine into the mice and dropped the mice onto the island for the snakes to eat.

Detail 3: Now, there are fewer snakes on Guam because of the mice.

Conclusion: In conclusion, scientists used Tylenol in mice to kill the snakes that were taking over Guam.

Escape From Slavery, page 25

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

1. pleading/scared/worried **2.** friendly/happy

3. unsure/worried **4.** scared/worried

5. proud/happy/friendly

Hamburger History/Tacos Take Over, page 29

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

1. Burgers and tacos are alike because they both often have beef in them.

2. Burgers and tacos are different because burgers came from Germany, and tacos came from Mexico.

Is It Wrong to Talk About the Election?, page 31

Answers will vary but should be similar to:

YES

1. It's better to keep our views private than to fight.

2. I don't want to be judged for my political views.

NO

1. Talking about our political views helps us become more accepting.

2. We must learn to share our views without fighting or putting each other down.

ACTION September 2016 at a Glance

Major Features	Language Arts Skills Development	Online Resources (all articles available on three levels)
Nonfiction, pp. 9-13 **"Lost in Death Valley"** BY KRISTIN LEWIS **CCR Anchor Standards:** **R.1, R.3, R.4, R.5, R.8, R.9, SL.1, SL.2, L.4, L.5, L.6**	**Featured Skill:** Text evidence **Key Skills:** Text evidence, text features, vocabulary, inference, figurative language, interpreting text, synthesizing, evaluating an argument	**Video:** Behind-the-Scenes (CC) **Audio:** Text-to-speech **Activities:** •Assessment (two levels) •Text Evidence (two levels) •Vocabulary Quiz
True Teen Story, pp. 14-17 **"I Saved My Friend's Life"** BY JENNIFER SHOTZ **CCR Anchor Standards:** **R.1, R.3, R.4, R.5, R.7, W.1, SL.1, SL.2, L.4, L.6**	**Featured Skill:** Inference **Key Skills:** Text features, vocabulary, close reading, key detail, cause and effect, supporting an opinion	**Audio:** Text-to-speech **Activities:** •Assessment (two levels) •Making Inferences (two levels) •Vocabulary Quiz
Readers Theater Play, pp. 20-25 ***Escape From Slavery*** BY KATE MARKS **CCR Anchor Standards:** **R.1, R.3, R.4, SL.1, SL.2, L.6**	**Featured Skill:** Fluency **Key Skills:** Fluency, text features, vocabulary, character traits, literary device, key details	**Video:** Action Time Machine: The 1840s; Harriet Tubman (CC) **Activities:** •Assessment (two levels) •Character Traits (two levels) •Vocabulary Quiz
Paired Texts, pp. 26-29 **"Hamburger History"** **"Tacos Take Over"** BY LAUREN TARSHIS **CCR Anchor Standards:** **R.1, R.2, R.4, R.9, W.2, SL.1, L.6**	**Featured Skill:** Compare and contrast **Key Skills:** Compare and contrast, text features, vocabulary, close reading, main idea and supporting details, cause and effect, informational writing	**Audio:** Text-to-speech **Activities:** •Assessment (two levels) •Compare and Contrast •Vocabulary Quiz

ACTION ONLINE SOLUTIONS
Answers to online-only activities for the September 2016 issue

"THE COOLEST DOG IN AMERICA" PROOFREADING:

1. d **2.** c **3.** a **4.** d

"THE TRUTH ABOUT ISIS" QUIZ (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** b **5.** a
2. c **4.** b **6.** d

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. ISIS members are killed if they try to leave the group.

8. Because ISIS leaders are Muslim, they have given some people the impression that all Muslims believe in very strict rules and harsh, violent punishments. The group has also hurt its own members if they try to leave.

"THE TRUTH ABOUT ISIS" QUIZ (LOWER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** d **5.** a
2. c **4.** b **6.** d

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. ISIS members are not allowed to leave. Those who try are killed.

8. ISIS is a terrorist group that has killed many people and must be stopped.

"THE TRUTH ABOUT ISIS" VOCABULARY QUIZ

1. terrorist
2. inspired
3. reject
4. refugees
5. conflicts

Answers for question 6-10 will vary but should be similar to:

6. terrorist . . . left the town
7. inspired . . . become one
8. refugees . . . our beautiful new school building
9. reject . . . I sent it in late
10. conflicts . . . meet with them

"THE TRUTH ABOUT ISIS" SUMMARIZING (HIGHER LEVEL):

Answers will vary. Accept all reasonable answers.

"THE TRUTH ABOUT ISIS" SUMMARIZING (LOWER LEVEL):

Answers will vary. Accept all reasonable answers.

"LOST IN DEATH VALLEY" QUIZ (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** d **5.** d
2. c **4.** b **6.** a

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Death Valley is very beautiful. It's also a historical site.

8. Because the air was so hot, the ground was also very hot. The ground burned the women's feet right through their shoes.

"LOST IN DEATH VALLEY" QUIZ (LOWER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** a **5.** d
2. b **4.** b **6.** a

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Death Valley is very beautiful. It's also a historical site.

8. You can die from heatstroke.

"LOST IN DEATH VALLEY" VOCABULARY QUIZ

1. ordeal
2. historical
3. dehydrated
4. jut
5. heatstroke

Answers for question 6-10 will vary but should be similar to:

6. historical . . . female mayor
7. jut . . . a porcupine
8. dehydrated . . . drink enough water
9. heatstroke . . . the summer
10. ordeal . . . pomegranate seeds

"LOST IN DEATH VALLEY" TEXT EVIDENCE (HIGHER LEVEL):

2. **Evidence**: Temperatures in Death Vallley can reach 125 degrees Fahrenheit. **Location**: In the section "Extreme Heat."

Answers will vary for questions 3-4.
Acceptable answers include:

3. **Evidence**: If a person's body overheats, they can get heatstroke and die. **Location**: In the section "The Search Begins."
4. **Evidence**: Few people can survive in such extreme heat. **Location**: In the section "Rescued!"

"LOST IN DEATH VALLEY" TEXT EVIDENCE (LOWER LEVEL):

2. **Evidence**: Temperatures in Death Vallley can reach 125 degrees Fahrenheit.
3. **Evidence**: If a person's body overheats, they can get heatstroke and die. **Location**: In the section "The Search Begins."
4. **Evidence**: Few people can survive in such extreme heat. **Location**: In the section "Rescued!"

"I SAVED MY FRIEND'S LIFE" QUIZ (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. d **3.** b and d **5.** c
2. a **4.** c **6.** d

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. The article states that doing CPR as soon as possible gives the patient the best chance of survival. Taylor's quick thinking allowed oxygen to get to Paris's brain and prevented brain damage. It also got her teammates to help out.

8. "My Teammate Saved My Life"

ACTION ONLINE SOLUTIONS *(continued)*
Answers to online-only activities for the September 2016 issue

"I SAVED MY FRIEND'S LIFE" QUIZ (LOWER LEVEL)

1. d **3.** b **5.** c
2. a **4.** b **6.** d

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Yes. Taylor feels good about saving Paris's life, so she wants to help save other lives by becoming a nurse.

8. I think the girls felt nervous because Paris was in trouble, but they also felt relieved that Taylor was trying to help.

"I SAVED MY FRIEND'S LIFE" VOCABULARY QUIZ

1. chest compressions
2. confident
3. cardiac
4. overcome
5. paramedics

Answers will vary for questions 6-10.
Acceptable answers include:

6. confident . . . studied hard
7. cardiac . . . ran more tests on him
8. overcome . . . heights
9. paramedics . . . injured
10. chest compressions . . . brain

"I SAVED MY FRIEND'S LIFE" INFERENCES (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. **My inference**: Taylor might have felt nervous and awkward when she was getting attention for saving Paris.
2. **What I know**: Saving someone's life by performing CPR might be part of a nurse's duties. When Taylor saved Paris, she got an idea of what it might be like to be a nurse. **My inference**: Saving Paris's life helped Taylor decide she wanted to become a nurse.

"I SAVED MY FRIEND'S LIFE" INFERENCES (LOWER LEVEL)

1. b
2. a

"WHEN KILLER MICE ATTACK!" PARAGRAPH WRITING

Answers will vary. Accept all reasonable answers.

"ESCAPE FROM SLAVERY" QUIZ (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. c **3.** c **5.** d
2. b **4.** a **6.** b

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Harriet Tubman recently made history by being the first African-American person chosen to appear on paper money in the U.S.

8. Harriet's actions showed that she was generous, brave, and determined to do what she believed was right. Because she worked hard to help others, she is still remembered today. You can learn that living with a purpose brings satisfaction and can help change the world.

"ESCAPE FROM SLAVERY" QUIZ (LOWER LEVEL)

1. c **3.** b **5.** c
2. a **4.** d **6.** b

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Harriet Tubman recently made history by being the first African-American person chosen to appear on paper money in the U.S.

8. Harriet showed her bravery by guiding hundreds of slaves to freedom when she knew she could be caught and punished at any time.

"ESCAPE FROM SLAVERY" VOCABULARY QUIZ

1. exhaustion
2. route
3. collapses
4. Underground Railroad
5. plantation

Answers will vary for questions 6-10.
Acceptable answers include:

6. Underground Railroad . . . brave and careful
7. collapses . . . sticks his feet up in the air
8. plantation . . . picking crops
9. route . . . the scenery is beautiful
10. exhaustion . . . I slept for a full day

"ESCAPE FROM SLAVERY" CHARACTER TRAITS (HIGHER LEVEL)

Answers will vary. Acceptable answers include:

Harriet was smart. I know this because in Scene 6, when they weren't allowed in by the stranger, Harriet still found a way to get them to freedom.

Harriet was courageous. I know this because she chose to help slaves to freedom even though she would be chained and whipped if she was caught.

Harriet was also kind. **I know this because** she gave her jacket to Ben when he was cold.

Harriet was also caring. **I know this because** she helped Ruth up when she collapsed.

"ESCAPE FROM SLAVERY" CHARACTER TRAITS (LOWER LEVEL)

Answers will vary. Acceptable answers include:

Harriet was smart. I know this because in Scene 6, when they weren't allowed in by the stranger, Harriet still found a way to get them to freedom.

Harriet was courageous. I know this because she chose to help slaves to freedom even though she would be chained and whipped if she was caught.

Harriet was also kind.

Harriet was also caring.

ACTION ONLINE SOLUTIONS *(continued)*
Answers to online-only activities for the September 2016 issue

"HAMBURGER HISTORY/TACOS TAKE OVER" (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. c **3.** a **5.** a
2. d **4.** a and c **6.** b

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. This is important because it highlights the challenge that Walter Anderson faced in making hamburgers popular in America and showing people that ground beef was safe to eat.

8. Immigrants helped make burgers and tacos popular in America by being the first to eat them here. If German immigrants hadn't eaten Hamburg steaks, the idea might not have caught on with other people, and Walter Anderson might never have founded White Castle. If Mexican restaurants like Mitla's hadn't served tacos in California, Glen Bell probably wouldn't have ever tasted one.

"HAMBURGER HISTORY/TACOS TAKE OVER" (LOWER LEVEL)

1. c **3.** a **5.** b
2. d **4.** a **6.** a

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. Many Americans didn't trust ground beef because dishonest butchers sold beef that contained spoiled meat and fat scraps.

8. Immigrants helped make burgers and tacos popular in America by being the first to eat them here. If German immigrants hadn't eaten Hamburg steaks, the idea might not have caught on with other people, and Walter Anderson might never have founded White Castle. If Mexican restaurants like Mitla's hadn't served tacos in California, Glen Bell probably wouldn't have ever tasted one.

"HAMBURGER HISTORY/TACOS TAKE OVER" VOCABULARY QUIZ

1. immigrants
2. founded
3. border
4. spatula
5. contained

Answers will vary for questions 6-10.
Acceptable answers include:

6. spatula . . . pancakes for breakfast
7. contained . . . eaten less of it
8. border . . . tacos
9. immigrants . . . sushi
10. founded . . . learn to cook many different foods

"HAMBURGER HISTORY/TACOS TAKE OVER" COMPARE AND CONTRAST

1. Hamburgers: Germans **Tacos:** Mexicans **Different**
2. Hamburgers: Most Americans mistrusted ground beef; they thought it would make them sick. **Tacos:** Most Americans thought Mexican food would be too spicy or would make them sick. **Similar**
3. Hamburgers: Walter Anderson **Tacos:** Glen Bell **Different**
4. Hamburgers: No, Anderson used ads to let people know that the food was safe to eat. **Tacos:** Yes, Bell made the taco shell crispier and the sauce less spicy. **Different**
5. Hamburgers: Yes **Tacos:** Yes **Similar**

"IS IT WRONG TO TALK ABOUT THE ELECTION?" QUIZ (HIGHER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** b **5.** d
2. c **4.** a **6.** c

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. I think the biggest reason it is wrong to talk about the election is that people can get into fights with their friends.

8. I think the biggest reason it is not wrong to talk about the election is that we need to share our views and learn from each other.

"IS IT WRONG TO TALK ABOUT THE ELECTION?" QUIZ (LOWER LEVEL)

1. a **3.** b **5.** a
2. b **4.** a **6.** d

Answers will vary for questions 7 and 8.
Acceptable answers include:

7. I think the biggest reason it is wrong to talk about the election is that people can get into fights with their friends.

8. I think the biggest reason it is not wrong to talk about the election is that we need to share our views and learn from each other.

"IS IT WRONG TO TALK ABOUT THE ELECTION?" ARGUMENT ESSAY (HIGHER LEVEL)

Answers will vary. Accept all reasonable answers.

"IS IT WRONG TO TALK ABOUT THE ELECTION?" ARGUMENT PARAGRAPH (LOWER LEVEL)

Answers will vary. Accept all reasonable answers.

ACTION ONLINE SOLUTIONS *(continued)*
Answers to online-only activities for the September 2016 issue

"THE ROSE THAT GREW FROM CONCRETE" AUTHOR'S CRAFT

Rhyme: concrete and feet

Internal rhyme: "Funny it seems, but by keeping its dreams, it learned to breathe the fresh air"

Personification: ". . . it learned to walk . . ."

Alliteration: ". . . crack in the concrete . . ."

Answers will vary for:

FIND THE CAUSES AND EFFECTS

FIVE W'S CHART

WHAT'S THE CENTRAL IDEA?

PROBLEM SOLVERS

SAME AND DIFFERENT

VOCABULARY JOURNAL

Scholastic Action Magazine • September 2016